Tessera.

Where we can get hurt, and how we answer.

Pitch pack 4 of 4: **tackling bleeds**. The soft spots a sharp jury will press, with short, honest answers. Plus our own loose ends to close before we go on stage.

READ TIME
12 minutes

USE IT FOR
Q&A rehearsal: one person asks, one answers, 20 seconds max

DATA
Synthetic world, Valentino is demo branding

HOW TO ANSWER A HARD QUESTION

Acknowledge, give a fact, bridge back

1

Acknowledge

“Fair point.” Agree with the true part first. Arguing the premise costs more than it wins.

2

One fact

A number, a design rule or a demo moment. One is enough; a list sounds defensive.

3

Bridge

Land on one of the three messages: stores see it first · every claim has a receipt · options, not orders.

DO

- Say “we measured X, we didn’t measure Y”
- Name the limit before they do: it reads as maturity
- Keep each answer under 20 seconds, then stop
- Hand over to the teammate who owns that part

DON’T

- Bluff a number, an ROI or a customer
- Present synthetic results as real-world results
- Quote or name the brand representative
- Go into the tech unless the question is technical

BLEEDS · THE BUSINESS CASE

“Do we actually need this?”

“Our stores already have real-time data.”

For the **numbers**, yes. A former luxury retail manager told us exactly that. What’s missing is the **why**: what customers asked for, tried on and refused. That lives only in what staff write or say.

Bridge → Stores see it first, including what sales never show.

“Logistics is slow anyway. What’s one day?”

Agreed, and that’s why we don’t sell “real time”. The value is (1) events that sales **never** reveal and (2) getting the warning before the shipping cut-off. When nothing feasible exists, the answer is “hold” or “verify”.

Bridge → Options, not orders.

“Store managers won’t write more.”

Step one reads the email they **already** send. Guided voice notes are optional: three or four questions per store or shift, not per person. Whether stores adopt them is a hypothesis a pilot would test.

Bridge → We read what stores already write.

“What’s the ROI?”

On synthetic data, any figure would be invented. The frame: sizes recovered × margin + wrong moves avoided + analyst hours. A read-only pilot in one region measures it on **your** numbers.

Bridge → Low-risk to try, because humans decide.

BLEEDS · THE BUSINESS CASE

“Will it fit how a luxury house works?”

“Will it push us to overproduce scarce items?”

No. Products with planned scarcity get an **insight**, never a “make more” recommendation. Short-term options are moves between stores and from the warehouse. Production stays a human decision.

Bridge → Options, not orders.

“Does it work for franchise and multi-brand stores?”

Not yet, by choice. We start with directly operated boutiques, where catalogue and stock data exist. Franchise partners have their own systems and authority; multi-brand stores may share no data at all.

Bridge → A narrow start that works beats a broad one that doesn’t.

“Why not just retrain the forecast with the notes?”

Those models are slow by design and not ours to touch. We leave the baseline intact, show scenarios beside it when the evidence allows, and flag days that shouldn’t teach it anything, like construction or a till outage.

Bridge → A decision layer on top, not a replacement.

“Isn’t this just a dashboard?”

A dashboard shows everything and asks you to find the problem. This is a **short queue** where each case has an owner and a deadline, the evidence for and against, and options that have already been checked for feasibility.

Bridge → Same sales, different reasons, different decisions.

BLEEDS · TRUST IN THE RESULTS

“Why should we believe the numbers?”

“AI makes things up.”

That’s why it can’t create a fact without a **word-for-word quote**, which code checks. It never produces a number used in a calculation, and it can’t approve. On our sample, 0 of 43 accepted product links were wrong.

Bridge → Every claim has a receipt.

“You built the data and then found your own events. Isn’t that circular?”

It’s a fair risk. To limit it: the world includes decoys, corrections and noise. We tuned on dev stores only and keep others aside. The product is **blocked at the operating-system level** from reading the answers. A placebo test shows where we beat chance, and where we don’t.

Bridge → We only claim what beats chance.

“Recall of 0.62 is low.”

Most misses came from 7 of 26 emails rejected whole by a strict validation rule. On the emails actually read, recall was 0.87. The rule is fixed, but we haven’t re-measured yet. And when unsure, we’d rather miss than invent.

Bridge → Honest by design.

“1.24 false alerts per store per day is a lot of noise.”

True, and we show it. Many are the **same episode split** into several cases, which is our next fix, or real signals the test world didn’t plant. The queue is ranked. A plain stock rule needs 4.29 alerts per store per day and still catches less.

Bridge → A ranked queue, not a feed.

BLEEDS · TRUST IN THE RESULTS

“Is it really earlier? Is it really an agent?”

“A one-day lead isn’t “weeks before the actuals”.”

Right, and we don’t claim weeks. When sales also catch it, the gap is about a day: the email arrives the same evening, certified sales the next. The bigger win is what sales never show: a defect reported by **12 of 12 stores**, demand for a colour the store doesn’t carry.

Bridge → Stores see it first, or alone.

“And for season-wide trends?”

There no method beats chance, including ours, so we **don’t count them** as wins. Tessera is strongest on specific products in specific stores, which is where allocation decisions are made.

Bridge → We only claim what beats chance.

“What’s actually agentic here?”

The investigator picks its own checks from the evidence, within a fixed budget. In two recorded runs on real models it took **different paths**: stock and route checks for the cardigan, a question to the store for the ambiguous sweatshirt. It reads; it cannot approve.

Bridge → The agent investigates; a person decides.

“What if the AI or the network fails during the demo?”

The demo replays recorded model answers with no network. A full 12-store run reproduced **identically** offline, 1,598 cases with zero differences, in under two minutes.

Bridge → Feasible today, not in theory.

BLEEDS · INFRASTRUCTURE AND RISK

“Is it on Fastweb? Is it safe?”

“Does it run on Fastweb?”

Reading and product linking run on Fastweb’s AI Factory, on an **EU-hosted model**, and so do the product embeddings. Be precise: the investigator currently uses another Fastweb model hosted **outside the EU**, and speech-to-text runs on our own server.

Bridge → Built on Fastweb’s models today.

“Store notes name VIP clients and staff. Privacy?”

No customer names are needed: the questions ask about products, not people. The demo uses fictional people only. **Automatic redaction before storage is designed, not yet built**: it is on the roadmap.

Bridge → Facts about products, not people.

“How does it plug into our systems and agents?”

It reads files and systems as they are and writes **drafts**, not bookings. Other agents can query it through a standard read-only connection (MCP), the same way vendors are opening their ERPs.

Bridge → No new system for stores.

“What happens when it’s wrong?”

A person sees the evidence before acting. Every approval is tied to the exact data it was based on and recorded, so a mistake can be traced to the sentence or the row that caused it.

Bridge → Every claim has a receipt.

OUR OWN LOOSE ENDS

Close these before we go on stage

WOULD HURT CREDIBILITY IF SPOTTED

- ☐ **Demo script uses Rome (ROM01) for the construction case** while saying "dev stores only". ROM01 is a hold-out store. Swap the case or say it openly.
- ☐ **Hold-out results don't exist yet** (issues #126, #127, #128). Never imply that they do.
- ☐ **Recall after the validation fix** hasn't been re-measured. Quote 0.62 / 0.87 with the reason, or re-run first.
- ☐ The **investigator model is hosted outside the EU**. Say so if asked about Fastweb or sovereignty.

SHAPE THE DEMO AROUND THEM

- ☐ The recorded cardigan run ends in **"notify owner"**, not a transfer, because routes were unknown. Present it as the system refusing to guess.
- ☐ **"Decision margin"** (time left before the deadline) wasn't measured. Don't claim it.
- ☐ One episode can be **split into many cases** (24 cases for one event at the Munich store, MUN01). Avoid that store in the live queue.
- ☐ The clarification reply UI and the live phone voice note are still open (#135, #191). Don't script them as live until merged.
- ☐ **Fastweb keys expire 25 Oct 00:00 UTC.** Record everything the demo needs before then.

CHEAT SHEET

If you remember only five answers

THEY SAY	WE SAY, IN ONE BREATH
“AI hallucinates.”	No quote, no fact. Numbers come from code. 0 of 43 accepted links wrong.
“Synthetic data proves nothing.”	Decoys and noise inside, answers locked away, a placebo check, and we only claim what beats chance.
“We already have real-time data.”	For numbers. Not for what customers asked for and couldn’t buy.
“Only one day earlier?”	When sales see it too. Often sales never see it at all.
“Would you trust it to move stock?”	It doesn’t move stock. It proposes checked options and a person approves.

When in doubt, say what we measured, what we didn’t, and what a pilot would.